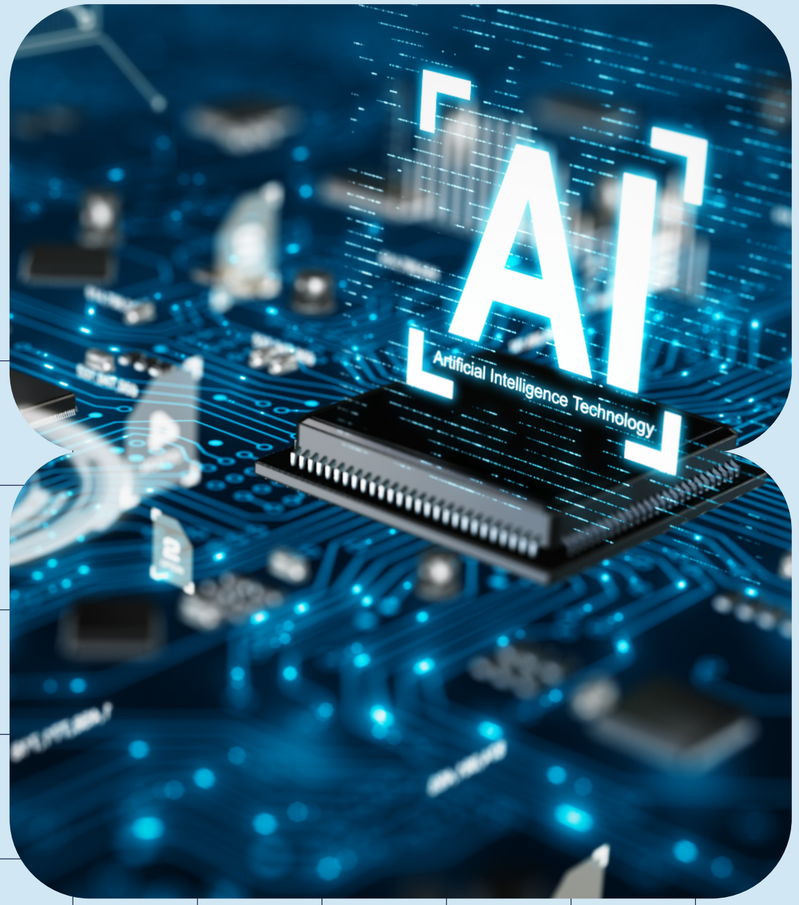
How AI Coding Tools Are Changing the Future of Software Companies

Could the technology big software companies embrace also help create their competitors?



10/19/2026 Larissa Vigil, Zimo Chen, Ebenezer Agyiri

AI helps developers build software

Writing code · Debugging · Testing

GitHub Copilot

Claude Code

Cursor

90% surveyed tech professionals use AI at work

80% believe AI improves their productivity

Source: Google DORA, 2025 State of AI-assisted Software Development (survey respondents)

Lower barriers. More competition.

If building becomes easier, what changes for established companies?

01

Smaller Teams

May build more with fewer resources

03

More alternatives

Open-source and lower-cost competitors

03

Subscription pressure

Paid products must demonstrate value

Nearly two-thirds frustrated with rising subscription prices

Source: Deloitte, Fall 2026 Digital Media Trends

Adobe vs. ArtCraft

Two sides of the same technology

Using AI to improve paid software - and to build free alternatives

Adobe

Integrating generative AI into established apps

ArtCraft

7 free, open-source alternatives created with AI coding assistance



AI Limits, Human Oversight

Important limitations

ArtCraft is an example of potential, not a full Adobe replacement

Missing Features — Independent tests found gaps in functionality

Usability Problems — Professional-grade workflows take refinement

Human Oversight — Testing, maintenance, and security still matter

~30%

reported little or no trust in AI-generated code

Source: TechRadar independent testing; Google DORA (2025)

What makes software worth paying for?

AI may empower independent competitors, but reliable products still require human expertise.

If comparable free alternatives become viable, established companies will have to show what makes their products worth the price.

